David Mwangi

Financial Analyst — Fintech and Payments Business Analysis

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Fintech and payments business analyst with 12 years of experience in mobile money, card payments, cross-border remittances, and banking operations in Kenya. Translates business, regulatory, and partner requirements into clear process maps, user stories, and acceptance criteria for engineering teams. Led requirements for three cross-border remittance corridors using ISO 20022 messaging and reduced failed payment transactions from 4.2% to 2.6% by analysing timeout and routing data with SQL. Works closely with product managers, engineers, risk, compliance, finance, and external partners such as banks and payment switches. Interested in payment interoperability, financial inclusion, and data-driven product decisions.

ANALYTICAL AND TECHNICAL SKILLS

Fintech and payment systems: Mobile money, card issuing and acquiring, ISO 8583, ISO 20022, real-time payments, cross-border remittances, QR payments, merchant settlement, chargebacks, payment routing.

Business analysis: Requirements elicitation, BPMN process mapping, user stories and acceptance criteria, gap analysis, UAT planning, stakeholder management, partner integration requirements.

Risk, fraud, and compliance: Fraud rule design with risk teams, KYC onboarding flows, AML transaction monitoring requirements, support for regulatory reporting requirements.

Programming and data analytics: Advanced: SQL, Excel. Working knowledge: Python (pandas), Postman for API testing, JSON and XML message analysis.

Business intelligence and reporting: Power BI, Metabase, payment success-rate and funnel dashboards.

Financial analysis: Transaction fee and interchange analysis, settlement reconciliation, business cases for new corridors and products.

Tools: Jira, Confluence, Lucidchart, Camunda Modeler, Swagger/OpenAPI.

Industry experience: Fintech, retail banking, telecommunications mobile money.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Savanna Pay (fintech, mobile money and merchant payments) Nairobi, Kenya
Senior Business Analyst, Payments *Apr 2021 – Present*

- Led business requirements for three cross-border remittance corridors, covering ISO 20022 message mapping, foreign exchange quote rules, compliance screening, and partner settlement; all three launched on schedule.
- Analysed payment failure data with SQL and identified timeouts at a partner switch as the main cause; revised timeout and retry rules reduced failed transactions from 4.2% to 2.6%.
- Redesigned merchant settlement reconciliation with finance and engineering, moving from manual spreadsheets to automated matching; unreconciled items older than five days fell by about 70%.
- Specified fraud rules for account takeover and mule accounts with the risk team and defined the data each rule needed with engineering.
- Write BPMN process maps, user stories, and acceptance criteria for two engineering squads, and run user acceptance testing with operations teams.

Rift Valley Bank (retail banking) Nairobi, Kenya
Business Analyst *Jan 2017 – Mar 2021*

- Gathered requirements for migrating debit card processing to a new card management system, including ISO 8583 field mapping and cutover testing for 1.1 million cards.
- Documented API requirements for the bank’s open banking gateway (account information and payment initiation) with the architecture team and fintech partners.
- Mapped data sources and validation rules for regulatory reporting on mobile and agent banking transactions with the compliance team.
- Built Power BI dashboards on agent banking transaction volumes and failure rates for the channel management team.

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Lakeside Telecom (telecommunications) Kisumu, Kenya
Operations Analyst, Mobile Money *Jun 2014 – Dec 2016*

- Monitored mobile money transaction exceptions and agent float reports for western Kenya.
- Documented dispute resolution procedures, reducing average dispute handling time from five days to three.
- Analysed agent network performance to support decisions on new agent locations.

SELECTED PROJECTS

QR payments interoperability pilot
Tools and methods: BPMN, Jira, SQL, partner API specifications

- **Problem:** Merchants needed a separate QR code for each wallet and bank.
- **Contribution:** Defined the shared QR payload requirements, settlement rules, and test cases with two partner institutions.
- **Result:** A pilot with 300 merchants processed 85,000 interoperable payments in three months.

KYC onboarding funnel optimisation
Tools and methods: SQL, Metabase, product analytics events

- **Problem:** 38% of new users abandoned onboarding at identity verification.
- **Contribution:** Analysed funnel drop-off and proposed simpler document capture and clearer error messages with the product designer.
- **Result:** Onboarding completion rose from 62% to 74%.

Payment routing analysis
Tools and methods: SQL, Python, Excel, cost and success-rate analysis

- **Problem:** Transactions were routed to partners by fixed rules regardless of cost or success rate.
- **Contribution:** Analysed success rates and fees by partner, amount, and time of day, and proposed new routing rules.
- **Result:** Average processing cost fell by about 9% with no loss in success rate.

EDUCATION

Nairobi Institute of Commerce and Technology Nairobi, Kenya
B.Sc. Business Information Technology *2010 – 2014*

- Second-class upper honours; final project on mobile payment adoption among small retailers.
- Coursework: systems analysis, database management, financial accounting, e-commerce.

HACKATHONS, CONFERENCES, AND PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

- **East Africa Payments Forum, Nairobi (2025)** — Panel speaker on practical ISO 20022 adoption for fintech companies.
- **Fintech for Inclusion Hackathon, Nairobi (2022)** — Business analyst and pitch lead for a team that prototyped a savings feature for informal traders.
- **Nairobi Product and Business Analysis Community (2019 – Present)** — Organises quarterly sessions on requirements writing and process mapping.

CERTIFICATIONS AND ADDITIONAL QUALIFICATIONS

Professional development (illustrative): Payments Systems Professional Programme, Eastgate Payments Academy (2020); Business Analysis Practitioner Course, Eastgate Payments Academy (2018).

Languages: English (fluent), Swahili (native), Kikuyu (native).

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